STARWEAVER®

Non-Graded Project: Cyber Risk Management in Action: From Threat to Response

Objective

Apply your end-to-end understanding of cyber risk management by simulating the complete risk workflow—from identifying threats to presenting mitigation plans—in a realistic business scenario using free tools.



Project Description

In this capstone project, you'll step into the role of a cybersecurity analyst for a fictional mid-sized tech company. The organization has recently expanded its digital services and is now facing multiple cyber threats. Your task is to identify, assess, prioritize, and respond to these risks using the frameworks and tools covered throughout the course.

You will create a threat model, evaluate risks with both qualitative and quantitative methods, prioritize threats using a matrix, develop a mitigation plan, and summarize your insights in an executive-ready presentation.

Follow these steps to do this project

Step 1: Build a Threat Model

- Use Draw.io to create a simple diagram of the login system or digital workflow provided in the case scenario.
- Identify assets, threats, vulnerabilities, and trust boundaries.
- Highlight 2–3 key threats for deeper analysis.

Step 2: Perform Risk Scoring

- Use Excel to rate each threat using a 5x5 risk matrix.
- Assign likelihood and impact scores.
- Calculate exposure using qualitative and (if possible) basic quantitative estimates (e.g., ALE = SLE × ARO).

Step 3: Prioritize Risks

Based on your scoring, sort the threats into High, Medium, and Low priority.

Use conditional formatting or color-coding to create a mini heat map in Sheets.

Step 4: Develop Mitigation Actions

In ClickUp, create a task board with at least 3 risk response tasks.

Assign each task a response type (Avoid, Transfer, Mitigate, Accept).

Add due dates, owners (fictitious), and notes linking to business impact.

Step 5: Create an Executive Summary Slide

In PowerPoint, build a one-slide executive summary.

Include a visual (heat map or bar chart), top 2 risks, actions, and one key recommendation.

Keep it high-level and business-focused.

Step 6: Compile the Report

Organize all your work into a simple report using the structure below for peer review and feedback.

Organize information following this structure for peer review

1. Title Page: Project title, your name, date.
2. Project Requirement 1 – Threat Model: Include your Draw.io screenshot or export.
3. Project Requirement 2 – Risk Scoring Table: Include the matrix or sheet used for risk scoring.
4. Project Requirement 3 – Mitigation Plan in ClickUp: Export or screenshot the task board.

5 Project Requirement 4 – Executive Summary Slide: Add your final one-slide PowerPoint export or screenshot.

6 Recommendations: Write one clear, actionable recommendation to leadership based on your analysis.

Instructions for Documenting and Sharing the Project for Peer Review

Document the Project

- Use a word processor (e.g., Word or Google Docs) to compile all materials into a single project report.
- Ensure clarity, structure, and that each required section is present.
- Edit for professionalism and business-appropriate tone.

Share the Project

- Save your full report and the PowerPoint slide as PDFs.
- Upload both files to the Peer Review area in the course platform.
- In your submission post, include a 2–3 sentence description of what you learned and what your report includes.

Peer Review

- Read at least two peer submissions.
- Provide constructive, respectful feedback on clarity, logic, visual effectiveness, and actionability.

By completing this project, you'll walk through the full cyber risk management process—from identification to executive communication. You'll reinforce your ability to use structured tools and techniques that translate technical risk into strategic action.